DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 15

Reporting analyst

Profession 15 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A reporting analyst produces the regular reports a business depends on: weekly and monthly packs, KPI updates and exception reports, delivered on time and checked.

What professionals do every day

Maintains report templates, refreshes data, checks totals, writes commentary, and handles requests for changes.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Leaders rely on regular reports. A reporting analyst makes them reliable, on time and easy to read.

- Late reports.
- Reports that change format each month.
- Totals that do not reconcile.

Skills you need

- Spreadsheet and BI reporting.
- Reconciliation.
- Commentary writing.
- Process discipline and checklists.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Microsoft Excel	Analysis and reports	Free online version	Microsoft 365 plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365/excel
Power BI Desktop	Dashboards	Free	Power BI Pro and Premium plans (verify)	powerbi.microsoft.com/desktop/
Google Looker Studio	Dashboards	Free	Free	lookerstudio.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Build a monthly report template.
Intermediate	Reconcile totals to source.
Advanced	Write a commentary with three points.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Monthly KPI pack for a firm.
- **Intermediate:** Weekly sales report for a chain.
- **Advanced:** Exception report for operations.

Client-ready portfolio project

A monthly report pack for a fictional shop: template, reconciled totals, commentary and a checklist for each month.

Worked example

Worked example. The report reconciles the channel total (11,100) to the source before any commentary is written.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Monthly pack with reconciliation

Business problem: A shop needs its monthly report on time with totals that match.

Steps

1. Refresh the source data.
2. Compute the channel and monthly totals.
3. Reconcile the channel total to the source total.
4. Write three points of commentary.

Expected output: The pack, the reconciliation line and the commentary.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

SQL

```
SELECT channel, SUM(amount) AS revenue
FROM orders
GROUP BY channel
ORDER BY revenue DESC;
```

Channel total 11,100 reconciles to the source total of 11,100. The commentary covers the best channel (search, 5,600), the weakest month (February, 2,100) and one action.

Common mistakes

- Changing the template every month.
- No reconciliation step.
- Commentary that restates numbers without meaning.
- Late delivery with no warning.

Freelancing opportunities

- Monthly reporting for small firms.
- Report automation for finance and sales teams.
- Briefs for 'monthly report', 'KPI report', 'reporting analyst'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Microsoft Excel help

Part of **Master Freelancing: Data Analytics and Data Science**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.